

October 11, 2023
Memo

In the current world, there are a lot of underlying inequalities in the economy. One of the largest disparities is the class difference of people based on income and wealth. From a historical perspective, wealth traditionally depended on power and connections to people, and being generationally wealthy was seen as “genuine” while gaining new wealth was seen as “fake” or of a “lower” status. This showcases the difference sociological impacts wealth and the way people obtained wealth had on a person’s social “image.” Nowadays, it is similar in the sense that wealth determines how people are treated by others of different wealth statuses. Working class people are the most common seen in society, and typically treat those of higher wealth statuses differently than they would treat those of a similar “class.” Additionally, those of societal “lower” classes are typically negatively thought of in society and are given access to less economic and social opportunities because of underlying social stereotypes. Economic opportunities are also what affect a person’s ability to advance in their economic roles. Typically education and familial connections give a person more opportunities by being able to pay for higher education and having personal relationships in the economy. Those who have less opportunity due to their familial economic status have many less opportunities to gain the resources they need to gain a higher economic status, perpetuating them being stuck in a lower economic class. These inequalities are what lead to class inequalities and large gaps in economic classes. In Cech’s “Trouble With Passion,” the disparity between classes is also highlighted by different paying jobs. Those who have passion in different occupations do not always opt to pursue those occupations because of the lower economic classes they are associated with. Even if someone is very good at a certain occupation and would boost economic productivity more in that occupation, the wage gap pushes them to opt for a higher paying occupation, which further shows how some people are unequally affected in the economy.

Question: What would an economy look like if there were a way to get rid of wage inequalities across different professions?